

End Times Paper:
A Fusion of Amillennialism, Pre-Millennialism,
and Post-Millennialism

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Introduction

This paper will examine what it means to be “not a lover of money.” The answer is essentially to love God rather than money, and to work hard to make money because he wants to “do all things for Christ” rather than be selfish and store up storehouses for himself (parable of Jesus). We see that religion serves as good business education to be moral, and that this religion is valid in society. Good religion generates good money and good society.

The end times debates have raged ever since Christ resurrected. I believe the history of the popularity of the theories was that historic pre-millennialism was popular, then it post-millennialism and amillennialism, then it now is dispensational pre-millennialism that is popular (with the others following in second).

The reason for this popularity trend was that pre-millennialism was popular during times of great trial because pre-mil essentially says that the world will get worse and worse until Christ comes back. Around AD 100, Nero was killing Christians left and right and burning them as torch-light. Pre-mil was thus popular.

But as Constantine was Emperor and legalized Christianity to be the state religion, Christianity became so popular and comfortable. Christianity spread everywhere and became dominant. Thus post-millennialism, and possibly amillennialism was popular because amil say that Christ is reigning already, which is a good thing, and post-mil says that things will get better and better because as the Gospel says, “The kingdom of heaven is like a leaven that grows and grows bigger and bigger and until it becomes like a mustard tree where birds can relax and take shade” (complete paraphrase).

Then there was World War I and World War II, where nearly the entire world was in jeopardy on a scale never seen before. This was thought to be the end of the world, and thus pre-mil was popular again.

It was dispensational pre-mil that became popular because the Jews were coming out of the Holocaust - it was thought that the Jews would be the next ones to go through the tribulation and so they were given their own state, Israel as nation.

Scofield's Study Bible, which was the source of dispensational pre-mil, was written around the time of the creation of the State of Israel.

In this paper I will examine different viewpoints of the end-times, but I will propose that I believe that historic pre-millennialism is the correct view. The reason for this is that I think that Christians go through the tribulation and things will get worse at the end of the world. But I'd like to say that I don't adhere to a script, and that I believe that the world gets better as well at the same time, and that the tribulation is spiritual rather than physical.

What I Believe

Before I tackle the thoughts of other scholars, I'd like to present what I believe is the correct end-times theory.

I'd like to say that the end-times is the hardest part of the Bible to discern because it deals with things that are in the future and haven't happened concretely yet. It is one thing to cite Greek words and their definitions, but it is another thing to predict that a certain President is the Antichrist.

Before I get into my theories, I'd like to ask for your open-mindedness, and for your patience in understanding that I am not writing from a place of certainty nor authority, but rather expressing my thoughts as I see them. Please do not judge my writing too harshly - they are just what I believe as of now on a light foundation - not a firm foundation of certainty.

What I believe is that Donald Trump may either be one of the Two Witnesses in Revelation, or may be the Antichrist.

The Antichrist is essentially the beast that comes up out of the sea (Revelation) and he controls the money because the Mark of the Beast is what allows people to purchase things.

Donald Trump is a businessman, and he has terrible businesses like casinos, and he sleeps around with porn stars - he is not exactly the Messiah that some Christians believe him to be. He may be the Antichrist.

But what is interesting about Trump is that he promotes Christianity very fervently. He is trying to get 500 Christians into top government positions. He speaks very favorably of Christians and I personally like his speech at the National Prayer Day.

Therefore, it is possible that the beast is spiritual and is controlling Trump rather than Trump being the beast himself, which is similar to Amil.

It says that the beast reigns for a time, times, and half a time, which is exactly the length of a Presidential Term. The Witnesses will prophecy for that length of time until the beast comes up and kills them. If you look at the 1260 days after Trump was elected President, that lies on July 4th. It is possible that Trump will die or be assassinated on that date.

I believe that Jesus already came back and we raptured to him spiritually. The reason I believe this is that I had a vision of the rapture - I was raptured to the third heaven.

The Bible says we will see Christ and be like him, and I believe I saw Christ and became one with him on that rapture. I believe I raptured around September 2024.

From then on, I experienced many spiritual things, and felt that Satan fell from heaven and that the dragon gave Trump power. I feel that Trump is hopeless and weak and that the Antichrist is controlling him, and Christians are trying to guide him in the right direction.

What I see in the world right now is that there is a battle between Christians and non-Christians, and that Christ is fighting from his White Horse and waging war. He is crushing the

evil ones, and the saints are being redeemed. Thus, the sins of people are being judged and subjected to tribulation, and the goodness of Christians are being purified and amplified.

It is a crazy season in our lives right now, where the Antichrist is sometimes winning in our lives and at other times Christ wins us back. You see, everyone that makes money is using the Mark of the Beast in order to make money. You have to have no money at all in order to not have the Mark. Thus, the tribulation is totally annihilating non-Christians, but it is giving tribulation partly to Christians who are not fully sanctified yet - who are accomplices of evil because of their sinful flesh (Romans 7).

Thus, the conclusion is that the tribulation is spiritual and not physical because we do not see locusts flying around or great earthquakes happening - these are happening on a spiritual level.

Hoekema and Different Theories on Eschatology

Hoekema¹ has a chapter on comparing different views on the Millennium.

The Millennium is the 1000 year reign of Christ written in Chapter 20:4. What's interesting is that Satan will be locked up for those thousand years as well.

The debate is between Pre-mil, Amil, and Post-mil.

Amil says that the Millennium is the "present reign of the souls of deceased believers with Christ in heaven" (260). It is a "victorious Christ is ruling his people by his Word and Spirit." It says there will be an "intensified form of tribulation and apostasy as well as for the appearance of a personal antichrist before the Second Coming." This belief in a tribulation and apostasy is shared by Premil, but not Postmil.

¹ Anthony A. Hoekema, *The Bible and the Future* (Grand Rapids, MI: Eerdmans, 1979), 260.

Similar to Amil, “postmillennialists do not understand the millennium as involving a visible reign of Christ from an earthly throne.”

The world will become a more Christian place as an “increasingly larger proportion of the world’s inhabitants are converted to Christianity through the preaching of the gospel.”

“Postmillennialists generally understand Romans 11:25-26 as teaching a future large-scale conversion of the Jewish people.” This is similar to dispensationalism.

Darby taught Premil, and he said that there is a “distinction between Israel and the church as two separate peoples of God” (277).

“Dispensational premillennialism shares with historic premillennialism the conviction that Christ will reign on earth for a thousand years after his return.”

The main thing about premil is that it has “the literal interpretation of prophecy.” Also, it divides Israel and the church.

In summary, amil says that there is no millennium or that the millennium is happening right now. It has a spiritualization of all the prophecies in Revelation. Postmil, says that the millenium is coming. It says things will get better and better until Christ comes again. Premil says that Israel and the church is separate, and it takes a literal interpretation of Scripture. It says that things will get worse and worse until Christ comes again.

Conclusion

I want to repeat, that my personal understanding of the Revelation of Jesus Christ is not accurate or precise. It is simply my best shot at interpreting the times. I am not claiming anything - please do not judge me. I am simply doing my best to apply Revelation to current times.

And I think it is important to do this. We need to constantly look at the time we are in and judge it against Revelation. If there is something that sounds the alarm, we must be ready to die for Christ. But it is not irrationality that should drive us, but rather an eager waiting for the redemption of our bodies.

And so there are basically three big theories of eschatology - Premil, Amil, and Postmil; however, I don't think any of them is perfect.

My personal opinion is that things will get worse for the unbelievers, and better for the believers, and that both believers and unbelievers will be present during the tribulation. Also, I believe that there will not be literal locusts, so this means that Amil's spiritualization is correct. And so, it is a combination of all three that I believe.

May we each be free to believe and speculate what we want, and eagerly await for Christ.
Maranatha.

Bibliography

Hoekema, Anthony A. *The Bible and the Future*. Grand Rapids, MI: Eerdmans, 1979.